

How are our thoughts and opinions formed?

- What external factors shape our thinking—news, education, family, or personal experiences?
- Are our opinions ever truly our own, or are they a reflection of outside influences?
- Are you aware of how your thoughts and opinions make you behave?

Can true altruism exist?

- Is it possible to perform a selfless act without any expectation of return or personal benefit?
- Do all acts of kindness have some element of self-interest, even if it's just feeling good about oneself.
- If an act of kindness is only performed when it is seen does this invalidate the act?

What does it mean to live a good life?

- Is the 'good life' based on internal measurements, external, or a balance of both?
- Can a person lead a meaningful life without relying on external factors like wealth or personal relationships?
- Does living a good life require the pursuit of virtue, pleasure, or something else?

Are we obligated to help others?

- To what extent do we have a moral duty to assist others, even if it comes at a personal cost?
- What responsibilities do individuals and nations have in addressing these challenges?
- Is there a limit to our obligation to help others?

What is the role of suffering in life?

- Can suffering be a catalyst for personal growth, or is it simply something to be avoided?
- Is it possible to live a meaningful life without experiencing any form of suffering?
- Does the way we respond to suffering define our character?

What is the value of truth?

- Is truth always preferable to a comforting lie, or are there situations where it's better not to know or reveal the truth?
- How do we determine what is true in a world filled with conflicting information?
- Is truth subjective, or are there absolute truths that exist?

Is there such a thing as free will?

- Are our choices truly free, or are they determined by factors beyond our control?
- Does believing in free will or determinism change how we approach life and moral responsibility?
- Can we hold people accountable for their actions if free will is an illusion?

What is the purpose of art?

- Is the purpose of art to provoke thought, to provide pleasure, to reflect reality, or something else?
- Can art be considered meaningful if it doesn't serve a clear purpose?
- Does art help you define what beauty is?

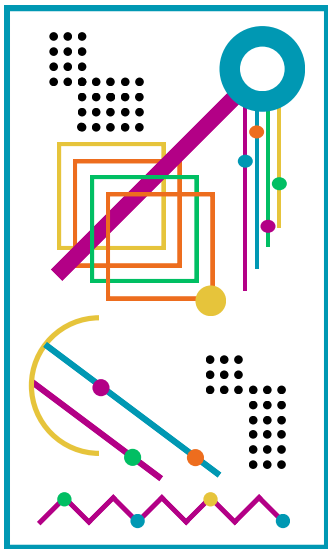
Can someone have an opinion without engaging in action?

- Is it hypocritical to express a stance without participating in it?
- What does it take for a belief to become more than just words?
- When might it be ethical to keep one's beliefs private rather than acting upon them?

How aware are you of the inevitability of change?

- Do we appreciate the natural occurrence of change in our lives?
- Why do humans resist change, even though it's inevitable?
- Can we find comfort in the idea that everything is always evolving?

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Socratic Sparks

Does the end justify the means?

- **Bentham:** Actions are justified if they lead to the greatest good for the greatest number of people.
- **Sontag:** Certain actions are morally wrong regardless of their outcomes and should never be justified by the ends.



Where does knowledge come from?

- **Descartes:** Knowledge comes from reason and logical deduction, emphasizing the role of doubt and reason in achieving certain knowledge.
- **Hume:** All knowledge is derived from sensory experience, and pure reason alone is unreliable without empirical evidence.



Are humans inherently good or selfish?

- **Hobbes:** Humans are naturally selfish and competitive, requiring a strong authority to maintain order.
- **De Beauvoir:** Humans are inherently good, but society corrupts them, introducing inequality and conflict.



What is the purpose of life?

- **Aristotle:** The purpose of life is to achieve happiness through living virtuously and fulfilling one's potential.
- **Camus:** Life is inherently absurd with no predetermined purpose, and meaning must be created through personal experience and choice.



Is human nature fixed or malleable?

- **Plato:** Human nature is fixed, with individuals born possessing certain characteristics that define their role in society.
- **Locke:** Humans are born as a 'tabula rasa' or blank slate, and experience and education shape their nature, making it adaptable.



Should individuals prioritize personal freedom or social order?

- **Mill:** Personal freedom is paramount, as long as it does not harm others, with minimal state interference.
- **Confucius:** Social harmony and order are crucial, with individuals fulfilling their roles and duties to maintain stability.



Can people change their fundamental beliefs?

- **James:** People can change their beliefs based on new experiences and outcomes that align with practical results.
- **Kierkegaard:** Fundamental beliefs are deeply rooted in personal identity and existential crises, making them difficult to change.



Is morality universal or culturally relative?

- **Kant:** There are objective moral principles that apply to all people, regardless of culture or context.
- **Boas:** Moral values and practices are shaped by cultural context, and what is considered moral can vary widely across societies.



What is the role of government in society?

- **Hobbes:** A strong, centralized authority is necessary to prevent chaos and maintain order, as humans are naturally self-interested.
- **Rousseau:** Government should be based on the general will of the people, promoting freedom and equality rather than imposing strict control.

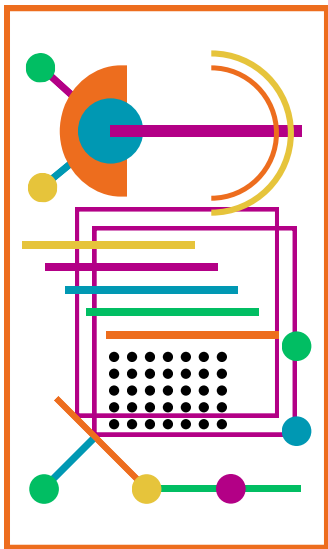


Is reality subjective or objective?

- **Locke:** Reality exists independently of our perceptions and beliefs, and can be understood through reason and evidence.
- **Berkeley:** Reality is constructed by our perceptions, and what we experience is shaped by our consciousness and personal experiences.



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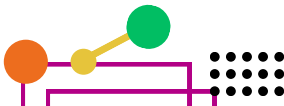


This Or That

Self Driving Sacrifice

You are programming an autonomous vehicle that must decide between swerving to avoid a pedestrian but hitting another car, or staying on course and potentially injuring the pedestrian.

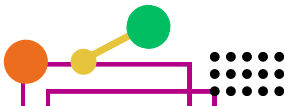
How should the vehicle be programmed?



Friend's Secret

Your close friend confides in you that they have been cheating on their partner for several months. They ask you to keep this a secret, but you also know their partner well.

What do you do?

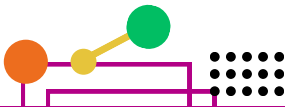


Equally Responsible

Two individuals are pushing rocks off a cliff.

One rock lands harmlessly in the river, while the other strikes and injures a swimmer below.

Given that both actions were the same, but only one led to harm, are they equally morally accountable for the outcome?

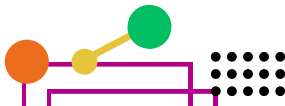


Lifeboat Dilemma

You are on a lifeboat with ten people, but the boat can only safely hold eight.

A storm is approaching, and if the boat is overloaded, it will capsize, killing everyone.

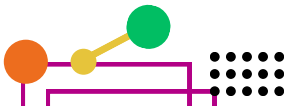
How does the group decide who stays on the boat and who is left behind?



Privacy vs. Security

As the head of a government agency, you have access to a program that can monitor all communications in your country, potentially preventing terrorist attacks but also infringing on citizens' privacy.

How do you balance the need for security with the right to privacy?



Rich Cat

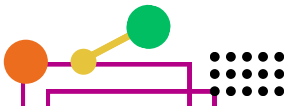
A wealthy individual dies and leaves their fortune to their pet cat, instead of their struggling family members. You are the executor of the will and have the power to override the deceased's wishes and distribute the wealth to the family instead.

Do you honor the will or provide for the family?

Bystanders Choice

You're in a crowded area when an altercation breaks out, and someone is being attacked. The crowd watches without intervening. If you step in, you could help save the person but put yourself in danger.

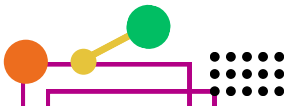
Do you risk your safety to help, or stay back like everyone else and avoid involvement?



Rope Problem

While rock climbing with a friend, you find yourself hanging from a rope with your friend below you, putting the rope under extreme tension. The strain makes it likely that you both could fall.

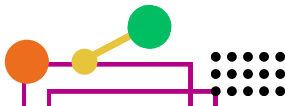
Do you cut the rope to save yourself, sacrificing your friend, or hold on and risk both your lives?



Honesty vs. Compassion

You are a doctor with a terminally ill patient who asks if they are going to die. Telling them the truth will likely cause great distress, while lying might give them comfort in their final days.

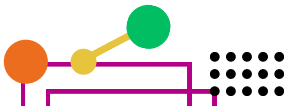
Do you tell them the truth?



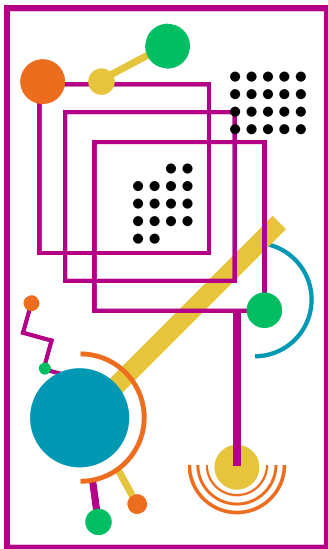
Finders Keepers

You find a wallet filled with cash on the street. Inside, there's a note that says the money is meant for a lifesaving surgery for the owner's child. You desperately need money to pay off your own debts.

Do you keep the wallet for yourself or return it, potentially saving a life but remaining in financial trouble?



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Moral Compass

Veil of Ignorance

You are given the power
to design your own
utopia—a perfect society
where you set all the
rules and principles.

How would you structure
it to ensure fairness and
equality for everyone?



The Teleporter

Imagine a teleporter that can instantly transport you from one location to another by scanning your body, disassembling it, and reconstructing an exact copy at the destination. However, the original is destroyed in the process.

Is the 'you' who arrives at the destination still you?



Experience Machine

Imagine a machine that
can give you any
experience you desire.
Once plugged in, you
could experience a
lifetime of perfect
happiness, love, and
success—all
indistinguishable from
reality.

However, once you enter,
you can never leave.
Would you plug in?



Perfect Simulation

Consider the possibility that our entire universe is a sophisticated simulation created by an advanced civilization. All of your experiences, memories, and the physical laws of the universe are just part of this simulation.

If this were true, would it change the way you conduct your life?



Expiration Date

Imagine a world where people are born with an expiration date visible on their forearm, indicating the exact day they will die.

How might this knowledge affect how they live their lives?



Time Travel

Imagine you have the ability to travel back in time and change a single event in your past.

However, this change could create unforeseen consequences in the present.

Would you still change the past, and how would you decide what to alter?



Moral Clone

Imagine a perfect clone
of yourself is created,
with all your memories,
personality, and thoughts
up to the moment of
creation.

If this clone commits a
crime, who should be
held responsible - you or
the clone?



Privacy or Connection

Imagine a future where technology allows multiple people to link their minds, sharing thoughts, memories, and emotions directly. While this could create deep bonds and connections, it also means losing some of your individuality and privacy.

Would you choose to connect with others in this way?



Mind Uploading

Imagine a future technology that allows you to upload your consciousness to a digital platform, where you can live indefinitely in a virtual world.

Is the uploaded consciousness still "you," and is this a form of immortality?



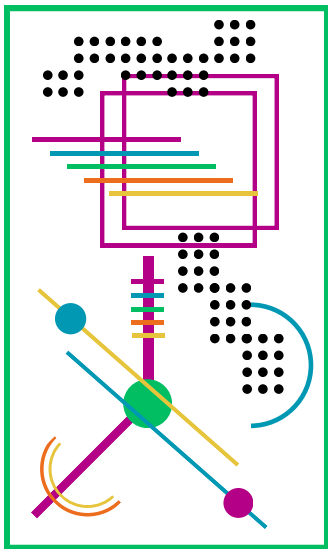
AI Companion

Imagine an AI is created
to be your perfect
companion -
understanding your
needs, emotions, and
desires better than any
human could. It provides
constant support, love,
and companionship, but
it is not conscious.

Would a relationship with
this AI be meaningful,
and could it ever replace
human connection?



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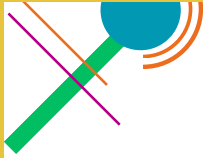


Mind Bogglers

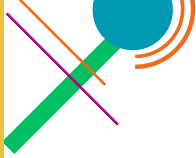
What is your
favorite color? Do
you know Why?



Is there a subject
that is too taboo to
talk about?



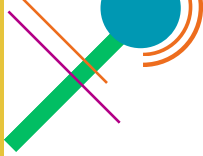
Is there a limit
to grief?



What is the meaning
of life to you?



What are you
afraid of?



What is Happiness?



Where does the mind
stop and the rest of
the world begin?

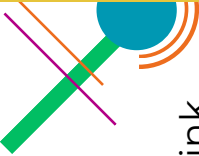




What do you consider
a characteristic of
intelligence?

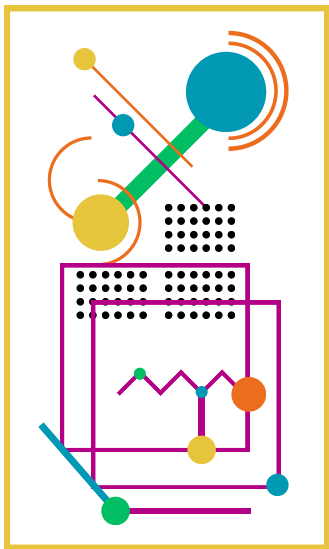
Do you believe
critical thinking in
society or general life
has diminished?





Of all your senses
which one do you think
has the most profound
effect on you?

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Know Thyself

About The Pack

This is your unique **Thinking.Cards** pack and can be used either solo or in a group, but there are no specific or rigid rules. Be intuitive, discover and create your own way of using the cards, your own games and rules. So, whatever you decide, each and any way will provide you with the inspiration for self reflection and new insights that will come from your **Thinking.Cards** pack.

Let us know what you come up with.



A Bit About Us

Thinking.Cards was born between two friends Chris and Sam, whilst on our weekly hikes along the trails of beautiful Colorado. The conversations that we had were thoughtful and reflective musings about subjects we were interested in, and they became a refreshing and enjoyable way to verbalize and reveal to us what was actually going on in our heads. As we continued our walks, the idea of recording these thoughts became an important discussion topic in and of itself.



A Bit More About Us

After months of writing, designing and refining, we created **Thinking.Cards** - the 50 cards of crafted thought-provoking questions that you now hold in your hands. We are very proud and excited to share our creation with you, and hope that, as you join us on this journey of mindful exploration, you enjoy it as much as we have.

Thank you for being apart of our community.

Chris & Sam



The Categories

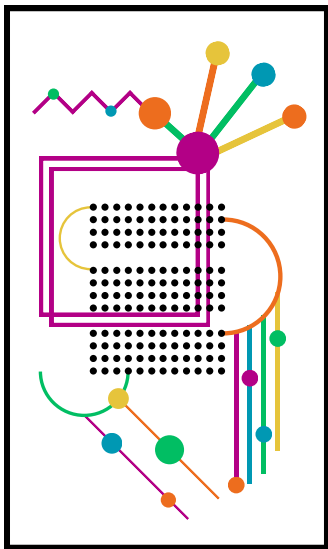
Here's a quick guide to what's inside your
Thinking.Cards pack:

5 categories of 10 cards each.

- **Socratic Sparks** – Open-ended philosophical questions to spark reflection.
- **This or That** – Cards presenting two contrasting philosophical viewpoints or moral stances.
- **Moral Compass** – Ethical dilemmas that force participants to choose between conflicting values or actions.
- **Mind Bogglers** – Complex, mind-twisting scenarios challenging pre-existing ideas and assumptions.
- **Know Thyself** – Short, focused questions designed for introspection and self-awareness.



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Challenge • Reflect • Connect